come bounding happily to us whenever we called her. We also noticed that a big ugly tomcat was keeping company with her. We didn't like his looks at all and disapproved of the relationship, but Putchikl ignored our lectures and seemed to find him tolerable.

On the night of May 3-4, right after that incident with the mouse in the kitchen, Putchikl didn't come when we called her to say good night before going to bed. We stayed up and she still didn't come. Eventually we had to go to bed, but of course I didn't sleep.

At 6:30 a.m. I became aware that it was raining, and I went to the backyard window to try to call her again. There she was, looking cold and unhappy, on the windowsill, and there was the faithful old torn, keeping her company. She clearly deserved punishment for her nameless orgies, but I took her in to dry and warm her and patted the torn, who then proceeded to go to his home next door.

She then found a younger torn, a virile one who ravished her before my very eyes. I expected Putchikl to be embarrassed about this, but she seemed oblivious to the dictates of virtue and kept whining to be let out so that she might be ravished again.

9

The Doctor's Orals, I understood, were to begin with a speech by the candidate, outlining his dissertation and explaining it. Only after that did his questioning begin.

Unwilling to leave anything to chance, I wrote out a speech and memorized it. I recited it to Gertrude, who listened patiently. Then I recited it to Dawson, who listened to the thirty minutes' worth and said, "Cut it." By May 14, I had cut it down to twenty minutes and. had to memorize the new version.

While I was doing this, the new state of Israel was founded, and the June 1948 Astounding came out with "No Connection." 5

Most of the letter column in that issue was given over to thio-

5 See The Early Asimov.

timoline, which made me uneasy. It was a bad time to remind the professors of the existence of the article.